

Reproductive Health

Chapter 3 · All questions with full solutions



Part 3 · Questions and Solutions

Q

1

Significance
of
reproductive
health



What do you think is the significance of reproductive health in a society?

Conclusion

Reproductive health is the total well-being in all aspects of reproduction.

It includes physical, emotional, behavioural, and social well-being.

Sexually transmitted infections, such as AIDS and gonorrhoea, spread from one individual to another through sexual contact.

Unprotected sexual intercourse can also lead to unwanted pregnancies.

So, it is necessary to create awareness among people, especially the youth, about various aspects of reproduction.

Young individuals are the future of the country, and they are most likely to acquire sexually transmitted infections.

Creating awareness about the available birth control methods, sexually transmitted infections and their prevention, and gender equality will help build a socially conscious, healthy family.

Spreading awareness about uncontrolled population growth and social evils among young individuals will help build a reproductively healthy society.

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2

Priority
aspects of
reproductive
health



Suggest the aspects of reproductive health which need to be given special attention in the present scenario.

Given



Reproductive health is the total well-being in all aspects of reproduction.

Aspects needing attention: The aspects which have to be given special attention in the present scenarios are

- Counselling and creating awareness among people, especially the youth, about various aspects of reproductive health, such as sexually transmitted infections, available contraceptive methods, case of pregnant mothers, adolescence, etc.
- Providing support and facilities such as medical assistance to people during pregnancy, STIs, abortions, contraceptives, infertility, etc. for building a reproductively healthy society

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3

Need for sex
education



Is sex education necessary in schools? Why?

Conclusion

Yes.

Sex education in schools is necessary.

It would give young individuals the right information at the right time about various aspects of reproductive health, such as reproductive organs, puberty, adolescence-related changes, safe sexual practices, and sexually transmitted diseases.

Young individuals and adolescents are more likely to acquire various sexually transmitted diseases.

So, giving them the right information at the right time would help them lead a reproductively healthy life.

It would also protect them from myths and misconceptions about sex-related issues.

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4

Reproductive health improvement in India



Do you think that reproductive health in our country has improved in the past 50 years? If yes, mention some such areas of improvement.

Given

Yes, the reproductive health has tremendously improved in India in the last 50 years.

Areas of improvement: The areas of improvement are as follows.

- Massive child immunization programme, which has led to a decrease in the infant mortality rate
- Maternal and infant mortality rate, which has been decreased drastically due to better post natal care
- Family planning, which has motivated people to have smaller families
- Use of contraceptive, which has resulted in a decrease in the rate of sexually transmitted diseases and unwanted pregnancies

Q

5

Causes of population explosion



What are the suggested reasons for population explosion?

Given

The human population is increasing day by day, leading to population explosion.

Major reasons: It is because of the following reasons.

- Decreased death rate
- Decreased maternal mortality rate (MMR)
- Decreased infant mortality rate (IMR)
- Increased number of people in the reproductive age group

Conclusion

The death rate, MMR and IMR have all declined in the past 50 years due to several factors: control of diseases, spread of awareness and education, improvement in medical facilities, and ensured food supply during emergencies.

Along with this, the number of people in the reproductive age group has increased - together these are the probable reasons for the population explosion.

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6

Justification for contraceptives



Is the use of contraceptives justified? Give reasons.

Conclusion

Yes, the use of contraceptives is fully justified.

The human population is increasing rapidly.

So, regulating reproduction to control population growth has become a necessary demand today.

Various contraceptive devices have been developed to reduce unwanted pregnancies.

This helps bring down the rising birth rate and checks population explosion.

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7

Gonad
removal as
contraception

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Removal of gonads cannot be considered as a contraceptive option.

Why?

Conclusion

Contraceptive devices are used to prevent unwanted pregnancy, and condoms specifically also help stop the spread of STIs.

There are many methods, such as natural, barrier, oral, and surgical methods, that prevent unwanted pregnancy.

However, the complete removal of gonads cannot be used as a contraceptive option.

This is because it would cause infertility and stop the body from making certain hormones needed for the normal functioning of accessory reproductive parts.

So, only those contraceptive methods that prevent fertilization should be used, not methods that make a person infertile forever.

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8

Ban on
amniocentesi
s for sex
determinatio
n

✦

Amniocentesis for sex determination is banned in our country.

Is this ban necessary? Comment.

Conclusion

Amniocentesis is a pre-natal diagnostic technique in which some of the amniotic fluid surrounding the developing foetus in the mother's uterus is drawn out to analyse the foetal cells and dissolved substances.

It is used to determine the sex and genetic disorders of a developing foetus by observing chromosomal patterns.

This method was developed to detect any kind of genetic disorder in the foetus.

However, this technique is being misused to detect the sex of the child before birth, and the female foetus is then aborted.

So, to prevent rising female foeticide, it is necessary to ban the use of amniocentesis for determining the sex of a child.

Q

9

Assisted
reproductive
techniques

✦

Suggest some methods to assist infertile couples to have children.

Given

Infertility is the inability of a couple to produce a baby even after unprotected intercourse.

It may be due to abnormalities in either partner, or in both.

The techniques used to assist infertile couples to have children are as follows.

Test tube babies: This involves in-vitro fertilisation, where the sperm meets the egg outside the female body.

The zygote that forms is then transferred into the uterus or fallopian tube of a normal female.

Babies produced by this method are called test tube babies.

Gamete Intra fallopian transfer (GIFT): It is a technique in which a gamete (ovum) from a donor is transferred into the fallopian tube of the recipient female.

This is done for a female who cannot produce eggs but can conceive and provide the right conditions for an embryo to develop.

Intra Cytoplasmic sperm injection (ICSI): It is a method of injecting sperm directly into the ovum to form an embryo in laboratory.

Artificial insemination: Artificial insemination is a method of transferring semen (sperm) from a healthy male donor into the vagina or uterus of the recipient female. It is employed when the male partner is not able to inseminate the female or has low sperm counts.

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10

Preventing
STDs



What are the measures one has to take to prevent from contracting STDs?

Conclusion

Sexually transmitted infections (STIs) spread from one individual to another through sexual contact.

Adolescents and young adults are at the greatest risk of getting these infections.

So, creating awareness among adolescents about their after-effects can help prevent STIs.

Using contraceptives, such as condoms, during intercourse can prevent the transfer of these infections.

Also, sex with unknown or multiple partners should be avoided, as they may carry such infections.

If in doubt, a specialist should be consulted immediately to ensure early detection and cure of the infection.

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11

True/False
on
reproductive
health

(())

State True/False with explanation

Part (a)

Abortions could happen spontaneously too. (True/False)

Conclusion

True //

Part (b)

Infertility is defined as the inability to produce a viable offspring and is always due to abnormalities/defects in the female partner. (True/False)

Conclusion

Infertility is defined as the inability of the couple to produce baby even after unprotected coitus.

It might occur due to abnormalities/defects in either male or female or both.

False //

Part (c)

Complete lactation could help as a natural method of contraception. (True/False)

Conclusion

Complete lactation, or lactational amenorrhoea, is a natural method of contraception.

However, it has been reported to be effective only up to a maximum period of six months following childbirth.

True //

Part (d)

Creating awareness about sex related aspects is an effective method to improve reproductive health of the people. (True/False)

Conclusion

True //

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12

Correcting
statements
on
contraception
and STDs



Correct the following statements:

Part (a)

Surgical methods of contraception prevent gamete formation.

Conclusion

Surgical methods of contraception block gamete transport and thereby prevent conception.

Part (b)

All sexually transmitted diseases are completely curable.

Conclusion

Some of the sexually transmitted infections are curable if they are detected early and treated properly.

Hepatitis-B, genital herpes and HIV infection (leading to AIDS) are still incurable.

Part (c)

Oral pills are very popular contraceptives among the rural women.

Conclusion

Oral pills are very popular contraceptives among urban women.

Part (d)

In E. T. techniques, embryos are always transferred into the uterus.

Conclusion

In the embryo transfer (ET) technique, embryos with upto 8 blastomeres are transferred into the fallopian tube (ZIFT - zygote intra fallopian transfer).

Embryos with more than 8 blastomeres are transferred into the uterus (IUT - intra uterine transfer).